



HIGH STRUNG

LASER LIGHTS at the Rs 850-crore Bandra-Worli Sealink in Mumbai, which will reduce driving time from 40 to seven minutes. The bridge hangs from 37,680 km of steel cables, nearly the length of the earth's circumference.

RAVIT SAHANI



THE GOVERNMENT BACKPEDALLED FURIOUSLY OVER THE CONTENTIOUS SECTION 377 RULING ON GAY RIGHTS.

DELHI | Playing it Safe

The Government picked up a hot potato, toyed with it for a bit and then decided to drop it, albeit gently. Last week, Law Minister Veerappa Moily indicated that the Centre might consider repealing Section 377 of the IPC, a move that the gay community has been campaigning for. Two other Union ministers seemed to support this move. This created the usual stir, with the BJP issuing its usual liberal warning that this was India and not the European community. The Muslim leadership at Deoband and beyond too voiced its vehement disapproval. This prompted Moily to immediately clarify that all that he had said was that the Government would discuss the law, and not scrap it. Health Minister Ghulam Nabi Azad spoke of evolving a broad consensus and parliamentary debate. Everyone knows what that means. Clearly not such a happy news for India's gay community, coming as it does after over the recent gay pride march in the country. *by Priya Sahgal*